

G Voce 90

A half-rack electric piano module in the spirit of the classic 90s EP modules.



Overview

G Voce 90 is a 12-voice electric piano module with five synthesised voices - no samples. TINE is a warm tine piano with a metallic 'ding' on the attack that barks when you play hard. REED is a reed piano with a soft-clipped bark. PLUCK is a short, bright, sticky-reed pluck. CLAV is a plucked string with a pickup and a damper that mutes it when you let go. BUZZ is a buzzy pulse-wave plucked keyboard.

The voices run through a chain of classic keyboard effects: DRIVE, TONE, VIBRATO (a stereo pan tremolo), CHORUS and AUTOWAH, then VOLUME. The autowah can follow your playing or sweep in time with the project tempo.

Twelve factory patches cover tines, reeds, clavs and more. Higher notes decay faster, as on the real instruments, and every note gets a tiny random tuning offset.

Reach for it for

- Soul, gospel and neo-soul electric piano parts
- Barking, driven reed piano for rock and blues

- Funky clav lines with an envelope or tempo-synced wah
- Stereo tremolo keys that move across the speakers
- Retro plucked keyboards (PLUCK, BUZZ)

Playing it

G Voce 90 is an instrument: it has no audio input and makes its sound from MIDI.

1. Insert G Voce 90 on a track.
2. Arm the track for recording and set its input to your MIDI keyboard (or draw notes in a MIDI item).
3. Play. The MIDI light at the bottom right flashes on each note.

It responds to velocity, the sustain pedal (CC64), pitch bend (+/- 2 semitones) and all-notes-off (CC120 and CC123). It listens on every MIDI channel, and incoming MIDI is passed on down the chain. Up to 12 notes sound at once; past that, the oldest note is taken over.

Controls

Patch and voice

Display	Shows the patch number and name. A * after the number means you have changed the patch since loading it. The second line shows the WAH mode and the DRIVE setting, or the knob you are turning and its value. Click the display for the full patch list, grouped into Tines, Reeds and Others.
PATCH up / down	Step to the next or previous patch.
TINE / REED / PLUCK / CLAV / BUZZ	Picks the voice. The lit key shows the one in use. Changing it applies to the next notes you play.

DRIVE

DRIVE	A gentle, slightly uneven soft-clip, 0 - 100%. Low settings (10 - 30%) are almost clean and only round off the peaks; higher settings add grit and bark. The level is matched, so it changes the colour more than the volume.
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TONE

A low-pass tone control, 0 - 100%. Lower is darker and rounder, higher is brighter.

VIBRATO

A stereo pan tremolo: the sound moves between the left and right speakers, as on the classic suitcase pianos.

RATE

The speed, 0.5 - 10 Hz.

DEPTH

How far it moves, 0 - 100%. At 0 it is off.

CHORUS**DEPTH**

How much chorus, 0 - 100%. At 0 it is off. The chorus crosses left and right for a wide image.

RATE

The speed of the chorus wobble, 0.1 - 5 Hz.

AUTOWAH**SENS**

How strongly the wah reacts, 0 - 100%. In ENV mode, how far your playing opens it; in the tempo modes, how far each sweep goes.

RANGE

How high the wah can sweep, 0 - 100%.

Q

The sharpness of the wah peak, 0 - 100%. Higher is more vocal and quacky.

MIX

The blend of wah and dry sound, 0 - 100%. At 0 the wah is off.

ENV / 1/4 / 1/8 / 1/16

Click to step through the wah modes. ENV: the wah follows how hard you play. 1/4, 1/8, 1/16: it sweeps open and closed once per quarter, eighth or sixteenth note, in time with the project tempo (locked to the beat while the transport runs).

MASTER

DRIFT	A slow random wander, 0 - 100% (25% by default). It very slightly moves the pitch (up to +/-20 cents at 100%), the TONE setting, the VIBRATO and CHORUS rates and the wah's centre, and sets how much each new note is randomly detuned (up to +/-6 cents).
VOLUME	The output level, -24 to +6 dB. Each patch also has its own level trim so the hottest patches do not hit the output clipper.
MIDI	Lights when a note arrives.

The header

OUTPUT	Folds the STEREO and OUTPUT controls out below the panel (and back in). The light shows when they are open.
S / M / L	Panel size: small, medium or large. The panel also scales to fit the plugin window.
?	Opens a pop-up with the design credit, the GFX website address and the address of this manual. Click anywhere to close it.

STEREO and OUTPUT (OUTPUT fold-out)

MONO	Makes everything below the set frequency mono, 20 - 500 Hz (fully left = OFF). Use it to keep the low end centred.
WIDTH	Widens the stereo image above the MONO frequency, from +0% up to +100% (twice the side signal).
SAT	Band saturation on the way out, 0 - 100%: only the lows and highs are saturated (the mids stay clean), with a soft curve that loosens as the level rises.
BIAS	Shapes the saturation: more bias adds more even (2nd) harmonics, for a warmer, rounder colour.
LO BAND / HI BAND	Where the low and high saturation bands start (40 - 400 Hz and 2 - 16 kHz).

CEILING / THRESH	With CLIP: the level the peaks are softly clipped at. With LIMIT: the threshold of a brickwall limiter that holds the peaks at -0.3 dBFS - pulling it down limits harder and makes the output louder.
OFF / CLIP / LIMIT	The final stage: nothing, a soft clipper (no latency), or a lookahead limiter (3 ms latency, compensated by REAPER). With LIMIT the gain reduction is shown beside the keys; with CLIP a red CLIP shows while it is clipping.

Patches

A patch sets the voice and every effect control; DRIFT, VOLUME and the fold-out controls are left as they are.

Soul Tine	The default: tine piano with light drive, some vibrato and chorus, and a gentle envelope wah.
Clean Tine	Tine piano almost clean: a little drive, no vibrato, chorus or wah.
Suitcase	Tine piano with deep stereo vibrato at 5 Hz.
Gospel Wah	Driven, brighter tine piano with a strong envelope wah and a little chorus.
Neo Soul	Tine piano with a slow vibrato, deeper chorus and a soft wah in the mix.
Reed Bark	Reed piano driven hard for bark, with a quick vibrato.
Reed Trem	Reed piano with deep, quick stereo vibrato.
Pluck Pop	Bright Pluck with chorus.
Funk Clav	Clav with drive and a strong, sharp envelope wah.
Sync Clav	Clav with the wah sweeping on every 16th note, in time with the project.
Buzz 70s	The BUZZ voice with deep chorus.

Tips

- For the classic bark, play harder: TINE and REED both get brighter and grittier with velocity, before DRIVE adds any more.
- With CLAV, let go of the keys sharply - the damper mutes the string in about 60 ms, which is half the funk.
- Use the tempo wah modes with the transport running so the sweep locks to the beat.
- If a patch is too wide for a busy mix, open OUTPUT and raise MONO to keep the lows in the centre.

File: gfx-g-voce-90.jsfx